

ComEd bills likely to remain high, as AI, data centers drain power

Posted by u/ghost_pug26 • 0 points • 8 comments

As if I needed another reason to be pissed about AI. Just got my ComEd bill today, over \$60 more than it should be (even accounting for increased electricity use due to air conditioning). Sure does suck paying more to survive our melting planet so business idiots can power their data centers.

Comments

u/Apprehensive-Fun4181 • 1 points • 2025-08-02 01:29 UTC

The **Chicago** Drain that The **Chicago** Times treats as just a story.

u/Underfitted • 6 points • 2025-07-29 10:28 UTC

This is actually one of the biggest stories that is intentionally being hidden by the financial and tech sector.

Energy is the fundamental cost of AI. The taxpayer is subsidising the entire AI infrastructure OPEX, that is wholly owned by private corporations, without even knowing about it.

People foolishly think the \$12B or so loss OpenAI is taking in costs this year is at face value.....no that is the loss after subsidies. MSFT is giving OpenAI a 20-30% discount on cloud credits and on top of that, utility companies are giving MSFT something like a 10-20% discount. The true cost without these subsidies would be 60-100% higher!

Utility companies and Big Tech are working 24/7 to keep it hidden from the public and the media has been barely reporting it. Big Tech also wants to hide how much energy these facilities are exactly using, so that local residents do not wake up and start protesting their operations.

The fact that utility companies have chosen to side with Wall Street/Big Tech over the very own people governments mandated these companies to provide for is angering enough....but to force every tax payer to be complicit in funding an industry that many despise is the boiling point.

Your bills go higher to fund the costs of infra that private companies own to make a product you despise and destroys the environment.

u/danielbayley • 1 points • 2025-07-29 15:07 UTC

...and steal your IP, and explicitly in an attempt to undermine your labor.

u/Character-Pattern505 • 14 points • 2025-07-29 01:54 UTC

Just ask ChatGPT to magic up some free electricity.

u/Fast_Professional739 • 10 points • 2025-07-29 02:21 UTC

You joke, but that's literally Sam Altman's plan

u/Character-Pattern505 • 5 points • 2025-07-29 02:24 UTC

I know. I can't believe any of these fucks are still around pissing away billions.

u/Granum22 • 26 points • 2025-07-29 01:54 UTC

So everyone ends up paying for AI wether they use it or not. Awesome.

u/ByeByeBrianThompson • 11 points • 2025-07-29 02:32 UTC

Doubly so when you consider how many government contracts these fools get for extremely dubious value. I will say one thing about Altman, dude knows how to lie.

u/IAMAPrisoneroftheSun • 8 points • 2025-07-29 01:50 UTC

The billionaires demand tribute!